

11th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education

Survey response 1

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GENERAL INFORMATION

Country name:
Latvia
Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report:
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I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education[1]

Is your country a State Party to the Convention?
Yes
Is the Convention directly applicable in your country 's domestic law ?
Yes
Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education [1]? [1] Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.
Yes
Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked ?
Yes

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence. Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with the respect to the right to education.

Education Law (Available: <https://likumi.lv/doc.php?id=50759>)

Article 3. Right to quality and inclusive education

(1) Everyone has the right to a quality and inclusive education.

(2) a minor child of an asylum seeker and a minor asylum seeker have the right to primary and secondary education, as well as the right to continue the education commenced after reaching the age of majority.

(3) a minor third-country national or stateless person who has no legal basis to reside in the Republic of Latvia has the right to acquire basic education during the period specified for voluntary departure, or during the period for which removal has been postponed, as well as during his or her detention.

Article 3.1. Prohibition of differential treatment

(1) the persons referred to in Section 3 of this Law have the right to acquire education regardless of the material and social situation, race, nationality, ethnic origin, sex, religious and political beliefs, state of health, occupation and place of residence. The provisions specified in the Convention with respect to discrimination in education have been incorporated into the national Constitution and domestic law.

Constitution of the Republic of Latvia (Available: <http://likumi.lv/doc.php?id=57980>)

Aims: Article 112 of the Constitution of the Republic of Latvia states that anyone is entitled to education. The State shall ensure that anyone may acquire primary and secondary education without charge. Primary education shall be compulsory. At the same time, Article 99 provides that anyone is entitled to freedom of thought, conscience and religion.

General Education Law Section 21(1) of the General Education Law states that Local governments shall ensure equal access to pre-school education institutions in their administrative territory to children from eighteen months of age (Available: <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/20243-general-education-law>)

The Republic of Latvia Cabinet Regulation No. 716 "Regulations Regarding the State Guidelines for Pre-school Education and the Model Pre-school Education Programmes" (Available: <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/303371-regulations-regarding-the-state-guidelines-for-pre-school-education-and-the-model-pre-school-education-programmes>) defines the aims and objectives of pre-school education, the values to be updated in the acquisition of pre-school education, the compulsory content of pre-school education, the principles of its implementation and the planned results of its acquisition; the basic principles of pre-school education evaluation, updating inclusive education and providing that the different needs of all children are met through environmental access, diverse methods, dialogue and collaborative professional support, thus increasing the participation of every child in the learning process and models of educational programmes that meet the requirements of the national pre-school education guidelines.

As the aforementioned provisions of the Education Law are binding in the implementation of education at all its levels and in all types of education in accordance with Paragraphs 5 and 6 of the Education Law, as well as in the application of the norms of the General Education Law, the Vocational Education Law and the Law on Institutions of Higher Education, one could conclude that the Convention is being complied with in the implementation of the national educational policy.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4). 1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

Yes

- If yes, please provide reference:

Rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation are implemented in the legal and policy framework (Education Law, Education Development Guidelines 2021-2027. (Available :<https://digital-skills-jobs.europa.eu/en/actions/national-initiatives/national-strategies/latvian-education-development-guidelines-2021-2027>), Sustainable Development Strategy of Latvia until 2030 (Latvia 2030) is hierarchically the highest national-level, long-term planning document. It enumerates the main tasks of the state and society to achieve balanced and development. Latvia 2030 outlines 7 development priorities (development of culture space, investment in human capital, change of paradigm in education, innovative and eco-efficient economy, nature as future capital, perspective of spatial development, innovative government and participation of the society), 7 strategic indicators (natural population growth, the GINI coefficient, GDP per capita, the ecological footprint, the Human Development Index, the Global Competitiveness Index, dispersion of regional GDP per capita), 11 objectives, 11 development directions, 42 areas of action and 27 performance indicators. (Available: <https://www.mk.gov.lv/lv/media/15129/download?attachment>)

Development Concept for Latvian Higher Education and Institutions of Higher Education (developed in accordance with Paragraph 1 of Section 70 of the Law on Institutions of Higher Education)

National Development Plan of Latvia for 2021-2027 (NDP2027), approved by the Saeima at the extraordinary session on July 2, 2020. NDP2027 is Latvia's main medium-term development planning document. NDP2027 envisages the strategic objectives, priorities and measures for sustainable and balanced development of Latvia for the next seven-year planning period to achieve the Latvian Sustainable Development Strategy 2030 (Latvia2030), the UN Sustainable Development Goals and to improve the quality of life in Latvia over the next seven years. (Available: <https://www.pkc.gov.lv/en/national-development-planning>)

Asylum Law

Available: (<http://likumi.lv/ta/id/278986-patveruma-likums>)

Date: Adopted: 17.12.2015. Entered into Force: 19.01.2016

Aims: The Asylum Law states that the Cabinet of Ministers shall determine the procedures by which a minor asylum seeker shall be provided with opportunities for acquiring education. On the basis of the foregoing, the Cabinet has issued Regulation No 488 of 26 July 2016 "Procedures for the Provision of Minor Asylum Seekers with Opportunities for Acquiring Education".

Cabinet of Ministers Order No 436 of 22 June 2021 "On Education Development Guidelines 2021-2027" (hereinafter - the Guidelines) provides for targeted support systems to strengthen inclusive education:

- Introduction of early diagnosis for learners starting compulsory pre-school education from the age of five;
- Ensuring the availability of support staff and activities in every educational establishment, strengthening the inclusive education approach;
- Strengthening the work of educational institutions in cooperation with parents to support learning and create an emotionally safe and positive environment;
- Increasing municipal ownership, coordinated and strategic management of municipal and community input to ensure the success of educational institutions in engaging young people, including children and adolescents, providing learning environments that promote learners' emotional well-being and a sense of belonging.

The profile of educational trends outlines the future of education in Latvia: it provides insights into universal (applicable to all levels and types of education) change and reveals the key at the level of the individual, the educational institution, the educational service and the education system.

☒

☒ According to the Guidelines, the role of an educational institution is to provide an inclusive and emotionally safe learning environment.

☒ In September 2015, UN Member States agreed on a renewed concept of sustainable development and the UN General Assembly adopted the resolution "Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development".

☒ The document sets out 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), with Goal 4 "Ensure inclusive and quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities" aiming to ensure that by 2030: equal access to quality education for girls and boys; equal educational opportunities in urban and rural areas; access to quality pre-school education, including Access to quality and relevant vocational education and modern skills training; Access to quality higher education for both young people and adults; Increasing the number of qualified teachers; Development of modern educational institutions that take into account the specific needs of learners; and to ensure that all forms of education and training integrate content that promotes understanding of sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and cultural diversity and its role in sustainable development.

☒ Inclusive and quality education is thus seen not only as one of the goals of the Agenda, but also as a means and a way for UN Member States to achieve all 17 of its goals. In the development of the Latvian Education Development Guidelines, the objectives of the UN Sustainable Development Goal 4 have been taken into account and included in the objectives and actions of the action lines of the Guidelines.

☒ In terms of curriculum and process development, the Guidelines aim to ensure the effective implementation of the improved curriculum and approaches in general education (including pre-primary education), with a particular focus on inclusive learning approaches, interdisciplinarity, STEAM, pervasive skills (digital literacy, civic participation), socio-emotional learning and learning

by doing.

Overall, the improved learning approach is based on the principles of learning-by-doing, an increased role for formative assessment, a more flexible approach to organizing learning, parental involvement in the student's learning, the school as a learning organization approach and an inclusive education approach.

The development of vocational education in Latvia during the period of implementation of the Guidelines is geared towards achieving excellence while ensuring inclusiveness.

Supporting the development of everyone means implementing inclusive education and providing support mechanisms to ensure that educational provision meets the diverse needs, abilities, skills and backgrounds of learners, thus laying the foundations for individual learning opportunities and pathways and for the development of each individual, increasing opportunities for participation in learning, community life, culture, sport, civic life and economic activities. Cooperation and targeted coordination of resources between all stakeholders - educational institution management and staff, parents, community representatives, local, national and local authorities, etc. - is essential.

The guidelines also offer institutional solutions to support everyone's development by ensuring an inclusive approach to education at all levels.

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It also plans to support the inclusion of children of returnees and immigrants in educational institutions by addressing issues of access to information for the diaspora; providing individual and practical support for the integration of returnees and immigrants; implementing professional competence development measures for teachers; offering advice and support materials for parents and improving pupils' Latvian language skills, etc.

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Measures to support and involve Roma pupils in education are an important priority, reducing the number of Roma pupils who drop out of school, do not complete compulsory education and do not continue to general secondary education.⁷⁵ The plan is to build on the successes of the following initiatives: cooperation between the municipality, schools, teachers and parents to identify Roma pupils at risk of dropping out and to provide them with individual support (including in certain subjects); support for Roma mediators; development of Roma teaching assistants in educational institutions with higher numbers of Roma children, etc.

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In the context of inclusive education, specific support measures are targeted at a number of specific target groups. Initiatives to promote the inclusion of formerly imprisoned young people and young people not in education, employment, or training (NEETs) in education and employment (by offering one-to-one mentoring support, preventive measures, etc.) need to be continued and strengthened. It is planned to develop methodological recommendations for learning the content of educational programs in prisons, which will be adapted to the specifics of the educational programs implemented in prisons. Changes are also planned in certain normative acts, for example, on the procedure for enrolment of pupils in educational institutions implementing educational programs in prisons, in order to provide prisoners with opportunities to acquire general or vocational education.

An important measure for the implementation period of the Guidelines is the establishment and implementation of an early prevention system for children, providing complex, systemically integrated pedagogical and psychological support to meet the child's developmental needs. Such a system should cover all stages related to the provision of children's developmental needs - research, assessment, and diagnosis, early and appropriate support (intervention) and monitoring, reducing the risks of developmental, behavioral and other disorders in children and addressing problems related to the capacity of municipal pedagogical-medical commissions and the coordination of inclusive education support centers.

Issues related to the coordination of support for learners with special needs; the assessment of learners' abilities, developmental level and health status in order to provide an opinion on the most appropriate educational program or support measures in the learning process and examinations; consultation on inclusive education for teachers, parents, professionals, stakeholders will be addressed systematically and from an interdisciplinary perspective.

Particular emphasis is placed on the need for early diagnosis of special needs and early intervention planning and provision, including the development of an original set of diagnostic tools and the validation of screening tools to assess children's developmental needs from preschool age, as well as the adaptation and provision of evidence-based multimodal intervention programs for children of different ages, taking into account their socio-emotional, behavioral, physical and cognitive development needs. It is essential that early prevention activities take place close to the learners' place of learning or living.

One of the objectives of the Guidelines (3.1.2) is to ensure high quality special education.

In the previous Guidelines period, changes were initiated in the network of special education institutions and a normative approach based on the principles of inclusive education was strengthened, whereby pupils with special needs receive education in special classes/groups or mainstream classes in general education institutions.

In 2021-2027, the network of special education institutions, the learning environment and infrastructure will continue to be improved, and material and technical equipment will be further planned in order to increase the capacity of special education institutions to provide quality special education and to provide the necessary support to learners with special needs.

The accessibility of special education institutions will be ensured, the adequacy of the educational infrastructure of school buildings for the implementation of modern learning processes will be ensured, support staff with appropriate qualifications will be provided, fragmentation of special education in administrative territories will be reduced and cooperation between several administrative territories in the provision of quality special education will be strengthened.

It is planned to implement a broad and complex support for the implementation of the teaching process (development of teaching materials, professional development of teachers and other specialists, consultations, etc.) in all educational institutions implementing special education programs and educating children with special needs, with a significant emphasis on the quality of special education institutions - development centers in the provision of methodological work to ensure the methodological function.

As of 1 September 2023, there are 10 special education development centers, the activities of which are regulated on the basis of the Cabinet of Ministers Regulation No 187 of 29 March 2016 "Regulations on the criteria and procedure for granting the status of special education development center to a special education institution".

The regulations stipulate that no more than two centers operate in the territory of the Kurzeme, Latgale, Vidzeme and Zemgale planning regions, and no more than four centers operate in the territory of the Riga planning region. At present, all planning regions of Latvia have special education development centers:

- There are three centers in the Riga Planning Region - Riga Strazdumuiža Secondary School-Development Centre, Riga 5th Primary School-Development Centre and Riga 1st Primary School-Development Centre;
- In the Kurzeme planning region there are two centers - Viduskurzemes Primary School - Development Centre and Liepāja Līvupe Primary School - Development Centre;
- Vidzeme planning region has one center - Valmieras Gaujas krasta secondary school - development center;
- In the Zemgale planning region there are two centers - Koknese Primary School - development center and Jelgava Primary School Valdeka - development center;
- Two centers in the Latgale planning region - Daugavpils Stropu Primary School - Development Centre and Rēzekne Primary School - Development Centre.

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Legal texts (Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.) prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education]

Yes

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education]

Yes

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Combating discrimination in terms of curriculum]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In primary education]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In secondary education]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In technical and vocational education and training]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In higher education]
Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In adult education and alternative learning]
Yes

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

Education Law

Section 3. Right to Qualitative and Inclusive Education

Section 3.1 Prohibition of Differential Treatment

(Available: <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law>)

Pursuant to Article 3.1 of the Education Law, a prohibition of differential treatment is stipulated, thus guaranteeing the persons referred to in Section 3 of the Education Law the right to acquire education regardless of the material and social status, race, nationality, ethnic origin, gender, religious and political affiliation, state of health, occupation and place of residence.

With respect to ensuring equal opportunity in education in the Republic of Latvia, the legislature and the government have passed all the requisite legislation that prescribes identical and equally applicable national requirements and rules for compliance with and the implementation of the Convention.

The Latvian state has a unified educational system, uniform standards for academic subjects and sample curricula for all educational institutions. The standard for each academic subject includes questions relating to civic education and value education, tolerance and respect for difference. The Ministry of Education and Science supports the implementation of various educational programmes in order to meet the needs of every student, while observing the prohibition of discrimination based on gender, age, race, citizenship, ethnic origin and religious persuasion.

General requirements regarding the prohibition of differential treatment in education have been laid down in Section 3.1 of the Education Law.

Education Law (Section 3, Paragraph 1) states that the following persons are entitled to education: 1) a citizen of Latvia; 2) a non-citizen of Latvia; 3) a citizen of the European Union, a citizen of the European Economic Area or a citizen of the Swiss Confederation; 4) a permanent resident of the European Community who has a valid residence permit in the Republic of Latvia; 5) a stateless person who has a valid travel document of a stateless person issued in the Republic of Latvia; 6) a citizen of another state, other than a citizen of the European Union, the European Economic Area or the Swiss Confederation or a stateless person who has a valid residence permit in the Republic of Latvia; 7) a refugee or a person who has acquired alternative status; and 8) a person who has received temporary protection in the Republic of Latvia.

In addition, Section 3 Paragraph 2 states that a minor child of an asylum seeker and a minor asylum seeker is entitled to basic education and secondary education, as well as the right to continue the commenced education after reaching the age of majority. Pursuant to Paragraph three of the same Section, a minor third-country national or a stateless person who has no legal basis to reside in the Republic of Latvia is entitled to acquire basic education during the time period specified for voluntary exit or during the time period for which the expulsion is suspended, as well as during his or her detention.

In the Section 3, Paragraph 3 of the Education Law the Prohibition of Differential Treatment in Education has been elaborated.

(1) The persons referred to in Section 3 of this Law have the right to acquire education regardless of the material and social status, race, nationality, ethnic belonging, gender, religious and political affiliation, state of health, occupation and place of residence.

(2) Differential treatment towards a person due to the conditions referred to in Paragraph one of this Section shall be permitted, if it is objectively substantiated with a legal purpose, the means selected for the achievement of which are proportionate.

(3) An educational institution established by a religious organisation is entitled to base on the person's religious affiliation, readiness and capability to act in good faith and loyalty in relation to the dogma (doctrine) of the particular religion, as well as a set of moral and behavioural norms, principles and ideals, which form the basis of the conviction of the believers thereof.

(4) It is prohibited to cause directly or indirectly unfavourable consequences for a person, if he or she maintains his or her rights with a view to prevent differential treatment.

(5) If in the case of dispute a person points to factors which could have been the basis for his or her direct or indirect discrimination due to conditions referred to in Paragraph one of this Section, the implementer of the educational programme has a duty to prove that the prohibition of differential treatment has not been violated.

(6) If the prohibition of differential treatment or the prohibition to cause unfavourable consequences is violated, a person has the right to request elimination of the violation, to receive legal assistance in accordance with the Ombudsman Law, as well as to bring an action to the court. A person has the right to request compensation for losses and remuneration for moral detriment. In the case of dispute the amount of moral detriment shall be determined by the court upon preference thereof.

(7) The prohibition of differential treatment in relation to teachers and other persons employed in the education system shall be governed by other laws.

(8) The term "discrimination" used in this Section and types thereof shall comply with the terms used in the Consumer Rights

Protection Law. [4 March 2010]

Section 3, Paragraph 8 of the Education Law contains the provision that “discrimination” and types thereof shall correspond to the terms used in the Consumer Rights Protection Law. Section 3.1, Paragraph 6 of the Consumer Rights Protection Law states that direct discrimination is an attitude towards a person which on the basis of his or her sex, disability, race or ethnic origin in a comparable situation is, was and could be less favourable than towards another person. Indirect discrimination is a seemingly neutral provision, criterion or practice that creates or could create an unfavourable outcome on the basis of sex, disability, race or ethnic origin of a person, except for the case where such provision, criterion or practice is objectively substantiated with a legal purpose, for the achievement of which proportional means are chosen. As the aforementioned provisions of the Education Law are binding in the implementation of education at all its levels and in all types of education in accordance with Paragraphs 5 and 6 of the Education Law, as well as in the application of the norms of the General Education Law, the Vocational Education Law and the Law on Institutions of Higher Education, one could conclude that the Convention is being complied with in the implementation of the national educational policy. Programme for International Student Assessment PISA 2022 lists Latvia’s education system as highly equitable. It means that education system of Latvia both attains higher overall performance and minimizes the impact of students’ socio-economic status on their performance.

According to international student assessment data, lower-secondary students (15-year-olds) in Latvia scored higher than the OECD average in mathematics and natural science, and almost at OECD average in reading. Latvia has a smaller proportion of students who lack basic skills, but the share of top-performing students is also smaller than the average in OECD countries.

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

Education Law

Section 3. Right to Qualitative and Inclusive Education

(1) Everyone has the right to qualitative and inclusive education.

(2) A minor child of an asylum seeker and a minor asylum seeker has the right to basic education and secondary education, and also the right to continue the commenced education after attaining the age of majority.

(3) A minor third-country national or stateless person who has no legal basis to reside in the Republic of Latvia has the right to acquire basic education during the time period specified for voluntary exit or during the time period for which the expulsion is suspended, and also during his or her detention.

General Education Law

Section 53. Enrolment of Educates with Special Needs in General Education Programs

(1) Educates with special needs may be enrolled in general education programs. The requirements to be imposed on general education institutions so that educates with special needs would be enrolled in the general education programs implemented thereby shall be determined by the Cabinet.

(2) The educational institutions shall ensure the availability of appropriate support measures to educates with special needs who have been enrolled in a general education program. The educational institutions shall draw up an individual plan for the completion of an educational program for each enrolled educatee with special needs.

Cabinet of Ministers Regulation No 556, 19 November 2019 (Minutes of the Cabinet of Ministers No 54, § 56), Requirements for general education institutions to enroll pupils with special needs in their educational programmes. Issued in accordance with the General Education Law, Section 53 (1).

The Regulations set out the requirements for general education institutions to enroll pupils with special needs in their pre-school, general basic education, and general secondary education programmes. The educational establishment shall provide the necessary support measures for the learner in accordance with Annex 1 to this Regulation.

Latvia pays special attention to promotion of integration of the Roma community into the Latvian society, by eliminating discrimination and ensuring equal opportunities to the Roma community in education, employment and human rights. Although a special Programme entitled "Roma in Latvia" has not been renewed, Latvia continues activities in this field. The main activities are related to education of Roma children and ensuring equal opportunities of Roma in labor market. A special program for professional training of teacher assistant with Roma background was developed. The teacher assistants significantly promote education achievements by Roma children and motivate parents of Roma origin to ensure that their children acquire education. The Council of Europe has highlighted this Latvian initiative an example of good practice.

One of the main priorities for Roma integration in Latvia is Roma children's education and prevention of segregation of Roma children. A special program "Teachers' Assistants of Roma Background" has been developed. The idea of the project was to prepare teaching assistants of Roma background and to facilitate their inclusion into school and pre-school educational institutions attended by children of Roma background.

Involvement of Roma community leaders in dialogue with the state and local governments is an important mechanism for promotion of Roma community inclusion. Children's and students education is one of the priorities of the Latvian Roma inclusion. The schools in cooperation with Roma teacher's assistants promote the socialization process and the inclusion of Roma children, encourage and motivate them to engage in further education. An important part of the program is social work with parents, by explaining them the importance of education for children. The level of public awareness rises and the existing prejudices and stereotypes are diminishing. This year the research on the current situation of Roma education possibilities will be done. The results of the research will be useful for preparing the recommendations for effective implementation of the national education policy in future.

One of the main priorities in the protection of children's rights is the conceptual formulation of a system of protection of children's rights. One of the main tasks of the children's rights movement is to activate a close working relationship between professionals and those families from whom children have been taken in order to help those families overcome social difficulties, and to promote the return of the children to their families. Several community organizations have been established whose main purpose is to provide assistance to children. The three having made the most significant contributions in this field are "The Latvian Children's Fund". These organizations run charity drives on a regular basis, which have resulted in funds that have been donated to orphanages, children from poor families and children who are invalids. These groups have been successful in securing effective assistance from local businesses and foreign sources as well. They are also actively involved in educational efforts and in the nutrition, care and development of children. Some community organizations take part in national children's rights efforts, actively suggesting activities and projects. The National Centre of the Protection of Children's Rights, for example, has signed an agreement with the community organization "Education for a Civil Society". The project involves attorneys, teachers, psychologists, educational experts and social workers from both government and community organizations. The ratification of the Latvian Children's Rights Protection Law can be considered as the most significant step toward true protection of children's rights and compliance with the UN Convention on Children's Rights. The establishment of institutions, both on a national and regional level, for the protections of children's rights is significant. The establishment of community organizations and their active involvement in the issue has been most significant.

Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]

Yes

Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In primary education]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In secondary education]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In technical and vocational education and training]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In higher education]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In adult education and alternative learning]
Yes
- Please provide details:
General Education Law Section 21(1) of the General Education Law states that Local governments shall ensure equal access to pre-school education institutions in their administrative territory to children from eighteen months of age (Available: https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/20243-general-education-law). Education Development Guidelines 2021-2027 (adopted on 22 June 2021) emphasize inclusive education at all levels, ensuring appropriate personnel, support measures to migrants, Roma children, as well as children from other vulnerable groups. (Available: https://likumi.lv/ta/id/324332-par-izglitiba-attistibas-pamatnostadnem-20212027-gadam)
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In primary education]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In secondary education]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In technical and vocational education and training]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In higher education]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In adult education and alternative learning]
Yes

- Please provide details:

Regulations Regarding the State Basic Education Standard and Model Basic Education Programmes

(Available: <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/303768-regulations-regarding-the-state-basic-education-standard-and-model-basic-education-programmes>)

9.5. the educational institution shall develop an organisation culture in which the diversity of pupils by gender, ethnicity, religion, state of health, language, intellectual development and other characteristics is respected, observing the prohibition of discrimination and differential treatment

Regulations Regarding the State General Secondary Education Standard and Model General Secondary Education Programmes
(Available: <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/309597-regulations-regarding-the-state-general-secondary-education-standard-and-model-general-secondary-education-programmes>)

14.8. the educational institution develops the culture of the organisation and creates a learning environment which is physically and emotionally secure and which respects diversity according to gender, ethnicity, language, religious beliefs, health status, intellectual development and other characteristics, observing the prohibition of discrimination and differential treatment

The conformity of the qualification of the academic staff, of the development policy and motivation system of the academic staff and as well as the accessibility to the higher education has important rule for quality assurance in the Latvian higher education institutions. Council of Higher Education has the right to refuse to accredit the higher education institution or college if they don't conform to any of the requirements referred to human resources politics and inclusive education.

In addition, higher education institutions and Quality Agency for Higher Education use the Standards and Guidelines for Quality Assurance in the European Higher Education Area (ESG) (2015) as a reference point for internal and external quality assurance systems in higher education. Some of the standards for internal quality assurance in higher education institutions are:

- ☒ Institutions should ensure that the programs are delivered in a way that encourages students to take an active role in creating the learning process, and that the assessment of students reflects this approach.

- ☒ Institutions should have appropriate funding for learning and teaching activities and ensure that adequate and readily accessible learning resources and student support are provided.

- ☒ Institutions should monitor and periodically review their programs to ensure that they achieve the objectives set for them and respond to the needs of students and society. These reviews should lead to continuous improvement of the program. Any action planned or taken as a result should be communicated to all those concerned.

Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

In August 2017, the Cabinet of Ministers approved Regulations on the Development of Education Quality Monitoring System Project implementation. The aim is to develop the education quality monitoring system, based on statistical information, results of comparative education studies, evaluation and analysis of students' achievements and other indicators of performance of education institutions, results of centralized examinations, licensing and accreditation, as well as teachers' work assessments, taking into consideration medium-term and long-term strategical goals and results. The main actions include: (1) the development of education quality monitoring system and approbation of tools for education quality monitoring; (2) development and implementation of education research programme, foreseen implementation of 8 studies; (3) strategic communication and analytical capacity rising and training of persons involved in education quality monitoring.

The effective monitoring and evaluation of schools is essential to the continuous improvement of schools' performance. Schools need feedback on their performance to help them identify how to improve their practices, and to allow them to be held accountable for their performance.

ESF Project "Competency Approach to Education Curriculum" implemented under SO 8.3.1. "Developing Competence Approach in General Education Curriculum" activity 8.3.1.1. "Piloting and implementation of the competency based curriculum" has completed the development of the new curriculum. The regulatory framework for the implementation of the new curriculum has been elaborated and approved by the Cabinet of Ministers: Regulation No. 716 of 21 November 2018 "Regulations on State Guidelines for Pre-school Education and Sample Pre-school Education Programmes"; November 27, 2018, Regulations No.747 "Regulations on State Basic Education Standards and Sample Basic Education Programmes"; and Regulations of September 3, 2019 "Regulations on the National Standard of General Secondary Education and Sample General Secondary Education Programmes".

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Legislation provides for inclusive education for all]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Teachers are trained on inclusive education and to value diversity]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Multiple and flexible learning pathways are provided for]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Multilingual and intercultural education is supported]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

General Education Law

Section 53. Enrolment of Educates with Special Needs in General Education Programs

(1) Educates with special needs may be enrolled in general education programs. The requirements to be imposed on general education institutions so that educates with special needs would be enrolled in the general education programs implemented thereby shall be determined by the Cabinet.

(2) The educational institutions shall ensure the availability of appropriate support measures to educates with special needs who have been enrolled in a general education program. The educational institutions shall draw up an individual plan for the completion of an educational program for each enrolled educatee with special needs.

Cabinet of Ministers Regulation No 556, 19 November 2019 (Minutes of the Cabinet of Ministers No 54, § 56), Requirements for general education institutions to enroll pupils with special needs in their educational programmes. Issued in accordance with the General Education Law, Section 53 (1).

The Regulations set out the requirements for general education institutions to enroll pupils with special needs in their pre-school, general basic education, and general secondary education programmes. The educational establishment shall provide the necessary support measures for the learner in accordance with Annex 1 to this Regulation.

Cabinet of Ministers Order No 436 of 22 June 2021 "On Education Development Guidelines 2021-2027" (hereinafter - the Guidelines) provides for targeted support systems to strengthen inclusive education:

- Introduction of early diagnosis for learners starting compulsory pre-school education from the age of five;
- Ensuring the availability of support staff and activities in every educational establishment, strengthening the inclusive education approach;
- Strengthening the work of educational institutions in cooperation with parents to support learning and create an emotionally safe and positive environment;
- Increasing municipal ownership, coordinated and strategic management of municipal and community input to ensure the success of educational institutions in engaging young people, including children and adolescents, providing learning environments that promote learners' emotional well-being and a sense of belonging.

The profile of educational trends outlines the future of education in Latvia: it provides insights into universal (applicable to all levels and types of education) change and reveals the key at the level of the individual, the educational institution, the educational service and the education system.

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

There is a shortage of support staff in education institutions. Availability of special educators; teachers' training in special education in mainstream schools, lack of teaching assistants, lack of teaching assistants in educational institutions able to provide individual support to a learner with special needs need to be addressed.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Legislation provides for gender equality in education]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Providing positive or affirmative action measures]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Providing financial incentives and fellowships]

No

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]

No

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education]

No

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for]

No

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities]

No

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM)]

No

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET)]

No

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) [1]: Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married. [1] Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: "a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition."

Yes

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Teachers are trained on intercultural education]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Multilingual and intercultural education are supported]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities]

No

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

State Language Policy Guidelines 2021- 2027

The goal of the State language policy is to provide sustainability, linguistic quality, and competitiveness of the Latvian language - the State language of the Republic of Latvia and the EU official language in the Latvian and global language market that includes measures for provision of learning and mastering of Latvian as the mother tongue, second and foreign language, improvement of teaching methodology for learning Latvian, perfection of professional mastery of teachers of Latvian language, preparation and issue of teaching aids and methodology tools incl. electronic ones, needed for learning and mastering Latvian that is to be supported within the project of Education Development Guidelines 2021-2027, as well.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

In 2022, the Parliament adopted amendments to the Education Law and the General Education Law, which provide for the transition to instruction only in the Latvian language within three years. According to the amendments to the laws, from September 1, 2023, the learning process is implemented only in the state language in preschool education and in grades 1, 4 and 7. From September 1, 2024, students of grades 2, 5, and 8 will start studying only in the state language, but from September 1, 2025, grades 3, 6, and 9 will also join. The opportunity to learn the language and cultural history of ethnic minorities is preserved - at the preschool and primary and lower-secondary education level, ethnic minority students will be able to learn the language and cultural history of ethnic minorities within the framework of the extra-curricular education programme.

A specific feature of education system in Latvia is vocationally oriented education in sports, art and music provided in music, art and sports schools (mūzikas skola, mākslas skola, sporta skola). It is the acquisition of systematized knowledge and skills, as well as the formation of values orientation in art, culture or sport concurrently with the basic (integrated primary and lower-secondary) education and upper-secondary education level. Vocationally oriented music and art education together with vocational education and higher education in music and arts compose Latvia's culture education system (profesionālās kultūrizglītības sistēma).

Cabinet Regulations on minority language and cultural history interest-related education programme sample and its implementation guidelines. Aim: pomotion of pupils' interest in preserving and developing their minority identity, language and cultural uniqueness

the minority languages and cultural history are taught as an extra - curricular courses of minority culture and language of three hours per week.

Indigenous people: [Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities]
Yes
Indigenous people: [The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Teachers are trained on intercultural education]
Yes
Indigenous people: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
Indigenous people: [Multilingual and intercultural education are supported]
Yes
Indigenous people: [Native language instruction is ensured]
Yes
Indigenous people: [Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
Yes
Indigenous people: [Other]
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Legislation provides for their right to education]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education]
Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [All administrative barriers to access education are removed]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers are provided for]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Auxiliary assistance is provided]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Multiple and flexible learning pathways are provided]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Accelerated learning programmes are provided]
Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Language classes to newcomers are provided for]

No

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Asylum Law

Section 8, Paragraph three, Clause 4 of the Asylum Law states that the Cabinet shall determine the procedures by which a minor asylum seeker shall be provided with opportunities for acquiring education. On the basis of the foregoing, the Cabinet has issued Regulation No 488 of 26 July 2016 "Procedures for the Provision of Minor Asylum Seekers with Opportunities for Acquiring Education".

Higher education institutions use the opportunity to provide fully or partly funded study places for refugees (Belarusians or Ukrainians). In response to the war in Ukraine the ministry in collaboration with higher education institutions (therefore – HEI) provides opportunities for Ukrainian students to continue their studies and work in Latvia. According to the Law on Assistance to Ukrainian Civilians (Article 13.1), students who are enrolled in full time higher education programs and who does not have the support under Erasmus+ mobility program (1050 EUR per month) can apply for scholarships specifically designed for Ukrainian civilians. Students of all study levels enrolled in public or private higher education institutions (including colleges) of Latvia will be able to receive a monthly scholarship payment of 140 euros from the day of enrolment until the end of 31st of December 2025. The largest institutions of higher education are supporting Ukrainian civilians in many ways, such as offering self-funded study places, granting discounts for study fees (Ukrainian civilians can apply for state funded studies, but the number of such places differ in various study programs – just as for the Latvian students) and dormitories, providing psychological assistance etc. In accordance with the order of the Head of the educational institution the minor is admitted to the age - respective educational program or pre-school group and is provided with an individual learning plan. The educational institution elaborates essential support arrangements including Ukrainian language, personal consultations, psychologist, speech therapist, social teacher and other school staff.

The teachers' salary of 257 EUR is paid for implementation of individual educational plan and essential support arrangements for each pre-school, basic and secondary education stage for a period up to one year.

A lump-sum payment equal to 50 EUR is available for each student to buy study supplies.

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People with disabilities: [Legislation provides for their right to education]

Yes

People with disabilities: [Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education]

Yes

People with disabilities: [Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured]

Yes

People with disabilities: [Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Auxiliary assistance is provided]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Other]
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:
Needs-based grant ("Studēt gods") has been operational since 2021, providing targeted assistance to students with disabilities, students from large families and orphaned students. The Ministry aims to expand this program in the future. Starting from the 2024 autumn amount of needs-based grant will be increased from 175 euros/per month to 200 euros/ per month. Students with disabilities can use state funded assistant service to attend all activities (formal/informal) in the higher education institution. Largest higher education institutions provide targeted assistance to students with disabilities, students from large families and orphaned students.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.
Old infrastructure of higher education institutions, insufficient funding for higher education in general.
Students from poor households: [Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided]
Yes
Students from poor households: [Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education]
No
Students from poor households: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided]
Yes
Students from poor households: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
Students from poor households: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
Yes
Students from poor households: [Other]
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:
From 2025 Autumn needs-based grant "Studēt gods" will be available for students from poor households.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free]

Yes

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable]

No

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis]

Yes

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play.]

Yes

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

On 21 November 2018, the Cabinet of Ministers adopted the new pre-school education guidelines, which will be implemented starting from 2019/2020 school year. The new guidelines define the results of pre-school education process, putting an emphasis on transversal skills and more active integration of children in the learning process. Teaching – learning programmes and teaching aids for pre-school have been developed and published. Teacher professional development activities are ongoing to ensure the implementation of the new curriculum to teachers, who implement mandatory pre-school education programmes for 5 and 6 year old children.

It is foreseen to develop a proposal for ensuring qualitative pedagogical process in pre-school education by balancing teachers' workload, remuneration and pre-school education institutions operation. . The Ministry of Education and Science (MoES) has set up a working group, where, taking into account the views of industry representatives, the current situation and the need to ensure a high-quality pedagogical process, proposals will be developed on the issues of work organisation, workload and remuneration of pre-school education institutions. However, planned changes are considered in the context of administratively territorial reform. Section 21 of the General Education Law states that local governments provide equal access to pre-school education institutions within their territory to children from the age of one and a half years.

Amendments to the Law on General Education of 21 June 2018 exclude special pre-school education institutions from the typology of educational institutions. Consequently, by 1 September 2020, local authorities had to take a decision on the future of a special pre-school education institution - a decision on the change of the type of institution from a special education institution to a general education institution; a decision on the merger of a special pre-school education institution with another education institution; a decision on the closure of a special pre-school education institution.

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is compulsory.]

Yes

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is not compulsory.]

No

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is free of charge for all.]

Yes

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is not free.]

No

- Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

Latvia provides a legal entitlement to early childhood education and care (ECEC, pirmsskolas izglītība) for all children from 1.5 years of age. Municipalities are obliged to ensure that children whose residence is declared in the administrative territory of the municipality are able to access ECEC the institution (pirmsskolas izglītības iestāde) closes to their home. ECEC for five- and six-year-old children is compulsory. Pre-school education for 5-6 year old children is compulsory. Education for younger children is optional.

- Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:

Each local government has an obligation to ensure that the children whose declared place of residence is in the administrative territory of the local government have the opportunity to acquire pre-school education at the local government educational institution closest to the place of residence of the child. Parents do not have to pay for the service. If a local government does not ensure a place in a pre-school education programme implemented by the local government educational institution to a child who has attained 18 months of age and whose place of residence is declared in the administrative territory of the local government (from 18 months of age until commencing the acquisition of basic education) and the child is completing the pre-school education programme in a private educational institution, the local government shall cover the costs for such private service provider in accordance with the procedures stipulated by the Cabinet. Costs shall be covered in the amount that corresponds to the average costs necessary for one educatee in the pre-school education programme in educational institutions of the respective local government (Available in Article 17, paragraphs 1 and 2 of the Education Law (Available: <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law>).

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.**- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Limited access]**

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Poor quality programmes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Poor learning outcomes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Low number of professionally trained educators]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Lack of support to families]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
On 29 September 2022, the Saeima of the Republic of Latvia adopted amendments to the Law on Education and the Law on General Education, stipulating that within three years the transition to Latvian-language-only education will take place (Available: https://www.vestnesis.lv/op/2022/197.1 and https://www.vestnesis.lv/op/2022/197.4). According to the amended law, from 1 September 2023, the pre-school education programme will be implemented only in Latvian. In order to support children who had previously attended pre-school education in a minority language, state funding was allocated for the recruitment of support staff (teaching assistants and speech therapists).
2.2 Primary and secondary education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.” Primary education - Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:
Section 32 of the General Education Law states that receiving basic education shall be mandatory. At the same time, Paragraph four of this Section provides that institutions in which students aged up to 18 years reside (child care institutions, orphanages, medical treatment institutions, places of imprisonment, accommodation centres for asylum seekers, etc.) shall ensure the possibility for receiving the basic education programme. The aim of the pre-school education program is to promote the development of human and responsible individual personality, to encourage the formation of inquisitiveness towards individuals, environment and society and its diversity and unity. Pre-school education programmes are acquired by children from the age of 1.5 up to the age of 7. Preparation of five and six-year-old children for the acquisition of basic education is compulsory. The majority of these education institutions belong to the municipalities, some are privately owned. Children with special needs usually attend general groups but there are a number of special groups and special pre-school institutions (37). The majority of pre-school age children who attend special groups or special pre-school institutions are children with speech and language development problems. Special support is offered to these children to develop their linguistic and communication skills. Normally a speech therapist and special education teachers are engaged to work with children. Primary and lower secondary education is organised as a single structure system (pamatizglītība or basic education), beginning at the age of 7 and consisting of nine years of compulsory schooling. Basic education ends after grade 9 with final examinations in student's first language, the Latvian language for students in ethnic minority programmes, mathematics, history of Latvia and a foreign language, leading to the award of a certificate which is needed to entry into upper-secondary education.
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is compulsory]
Yes
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is not compulsory.]
No
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is free of charge.]
Yes
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is not free.]
No

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Primary and lower secondary education is organised as a single structure system (pamatizglītība or basic education), beginning at the age of 7 and consisting of nine years of compulsory schooling. Basic education ends after grade 9 with final examinations in student's first language, the Latvian language for students in ethnic minority programmes, mathematics, history of Latvia and a foreign language, leading to the award of a certificate which is needed to entry into upper-secondary education.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [High dropout rates]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor quality programmes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in foundation literacy]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in numeracy]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in social and emotional learning]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Other poor learning outcomes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Disparity in learning outcomes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]

No

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Secondary education In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training. - Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

The lower secondary education starts at the age 13.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

Upper secondary education (vidējā izglītība) begins at the age of 16 and ends at the age of 19, and is provided in general and vocational pathways by vidusskola, ģimnāzija and profesionālās izglītības iestāde. Although upper-secondary education is not compulsory, the proportion of population with completed upper secondary education is still high and above the OECD average

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is compulsory.]

Yes

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is not compulsory.]

No

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is free of charge.]

Yes

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is not free of charge.]

No

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is compulsory.]

No

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is not compulsory.]

Yes

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is free of charge]

Yes

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is not free of charge.]

No

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education: For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

Since March 2017, the State Education Quality Service has been implementing the project 'Support for the reduction of early school leaving' (ESF 8.3.4.0/16/I/001) involving more than 95% of municipalities and 584 general and vocational education and training (VET) providers.
In general education an improved competence-based education content was fully introduced by 2023. Share of population aged 25–34 with tertiary education attainment in Latvia is above the EU average, but adults' participation in lifelong learning, according to the Labour Force Survey, is below the EU average.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [High dropout rates]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Poor quality programmes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Poor learning outcomes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Low readiness of primary graduates]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Other]

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is free of charge]

No

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures]

No

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).]

No

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Other]

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

The current higher education financing arrangement stimulated higher education institutions to fill state-subsidised study places, which resulted in reduced admission requirements, which in turn contributed to student drop-out. The pilot project envisages that the Ministry of Education and Science concludes an agreement with Riga Tehnical University (RTU) on the training of a certain number of specialists and other achievable indicators, and will allocate the relevant state funding. RTU will be granted the right to determine the number of study places and financing principles. Thus, the RTU Council will be able to make more rational decisions within the framework of the overall funding.

The main goal of the amendments to the Law on Higher Education Institutions is to improve and modernize the existing financing model of state higher education institutions, strengthening compliance with the demand of the national economy. The biggest challenges in the field of higher education are currently related to the high dropout rate of students and insufficient number of STEM graduates.

Riga Technical University starts the pilot project from January 2024, ensuring greater efficiency and better results, which objectively confirms the ongoing reforms at the university. Other universities are expected to join in implementing the institutional funding model within one to two years.

Direct costs

1. ☒ Tuition fees (40,7% of Latvian students studied in the state-funded budget places (2023), 59,2% of Latvian students studied in)

- ☒ Most common: 2200 euro/ per year;

- ☒ Minimum: 900 euro/ per year;

- ☒ Maximum: 13 000 euro/ per year (highly performative Medical study programmes).

2. ☒ Average enrolment fee: 30 euro

Indirect costs

- ☒ Exam fees: not applicable

- ☒ University supplies: The amount for one state-funded study place does not cover all expenses for study process. Sometimes students cover expenses of study materials (for example, printed materials, supplies for art students, architecture etc.) themselves.

- ☒ Transport: Monthly public transportation in capital city Riga – 12 euros/ per month; availability of student discounts depends on municipality

- ☒ Accommodation: Largest higher education institutions provide student housing; rental fees depend on the chosen type of room/ apartment. Amount of rental fee differs from 55 euros/ per month to 455 euros/ per month (mostly more expensive rooms are for newly renovated rooms/ apartments). Largest higher education institutions provide specially designed programs for disadvantaged students to reduce a fee for student dormitories.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Poor quality programmes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Poor learning outcomes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Low number of professionally trained professors]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Other]

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of literacy programmes]

No

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of free of charge learning opportunities]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Other]

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

Basic (EQF 1-2) and secondary (EQF 3) general education in Latvia is provided free of charge, also for adults, in the State and municipal education institutions, including opportunities to obtain it remotely or in part-time studies.

Initial Vocational education in the State and municipal vocational education (VET) institutions (more than 90% of all VET institutions) is also free of charge. VET has been fully modernized during the last decade, including the provision of flexibility and openness to adults, e.g., the modular approach to VET programmes have been introduced. The flexibility of vocational education was further strengthened in 2023 with the adoption of a regulation on admission to later stages of VET programs based on skills assessment ; and approving the regulation of enrolment and withdrawal VET programmes , among other things, ensuring the assignment of the actual professional qualification level to those who have left VET prematurely.

To promote better quality in adult education, the Parliament in 2022 has adopted Amendments to the Education Law regarding the implementation of the non-formal education programmes. The Amendments determining that non-formal education programmes should further include description of achievable learning outcomes, language of instruction, content, material and human resources necessary for the implementation of the programme. An education document – a certificate (aplēcība) – will be issued for the completion of the non-formal education programme. The regulation has been approved in 2023, established a unified procedure for issuing and cancelling a non-formal education programme permit by a municipality in order to promote the availability and quality of non-formal education, including digital skills. The regulation envisages also the unified approach for digital skills evaluation and assessment using a DigComp framework also within non-formal education programmes.

Considering demographic challenges, digital transformation and the need to rise productivity, human capital issues are one of the priorities. More than 200 million euros from various foreign financial instruments have been directed to the re-skilling, up-skilling, and re-qualification in various support programmes (2023-2029).

By the end of 2023, the implementation of the EU funds project "Improvement of Professional Competence of Employed Persons" has been finished. The Project covered support for obtaining continuous vocational education (CVET), professional development educational programmes, modular vocational education, study courses or study module programmes as well as the assessment of professional competence acquired outside the formal education system for the employed adults from 25 years old, including those having low level of education. For the Project period (2017- 2023), 66 592 unique employed persons (including 14 327 with low level of education) were involved in education programmes. The total funding allocated for the project implementation was 44 million EUR, including ESF financing - 34.4 million EUR and state budget co-financing – 6.6 million EUR.

The support with stronger focus on low-educated persons will continue also through the period 2024-2029. Within the programme "Support for adult education based on the individual needs of adults" managed by the Ministry of Education and Science The purpose of the project is re-skilling and up-skilling of the employed persons according to the needs of the labour market. Support will be given to more than 28 thousand employed persons, including 14 thousand low-skilled (persons with completed or incomplete basic education or general secondary education). The total eligible funding of the programme is 34.6 million EUR.

ES Fund Plus programme "Support measures for adult education based on sectoral needs and the procedure for their implementation" is under implementation. The purpose of the programme is to provide support for employers' growth needs-based, target-oriented increase of employee competence. The total eligible funding of which is 14.5 million EUR.

To reduce the social impact of the transition of the peat sector to climate neutrality in the most affected areas, within the framework of the Just transition fund 16.9 million EUR have been planned for improving the skills of employees and obtaining professional qualifications. Project implementation period is planned from 2024 to 2029 and support will be given to more than 5,6 thousand persons.

The State employment agency provides support to the unemployed, jobseekers and those at risk of unemployment. At the same time, any adult, regardless of employment status, can receive individual career counselling at the agency. Career development support and skills profiling are part of the State's support measures for adults. The development and piloting of the Individual learning account (ILA) approach is ongoing in Latvia. The Ministry of Education and Science has developed, and the Cabinet of Ministers has approved the regulatory framework for the implementation of the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) investment 2.3.1.4. "Development of the Individual Learning Account" approach. The ILA will be a personal virtual account that provides adults with access to a personalised learning budget and learning opportunities that meet state-set criteria and labour market needs. The ILA is expected to include a unified information and service platform for adult education and support opportunities, including tools for assessing skills. The project will provide free of charge career guidance and counselling for adults before involvement in the learning process. The new approach will also ensure unified access to qualification documents, certificates, and attestations for the education obtained. It is planned to pilot the ILA approach in Latvia by mid-2026, involving 3,500 participants in the pilot project, focusing on the acquisition of digital skills.

Within the framework of the RRF project "Development of digital skills of society", by the middle of 2026, 40,000 adults aged 16-74 without or with a low level of digital literacy will be provided with the opportunity to improve self-service digital skills, incl. with the support of a mentor. The aim of the project is to boost the development of basic digital skills in society, thereby promoting the integration of individuals in modern society, providing opportunities to solve household issues more effectively, use state and local government digital services and information.

Participation in adult education in Latvia is growing. The proportion of population aged 25-64 who participated in education in the last four weeks before the survey, has increased from 6.6% in 2020 to 9.7% in 2022 and to 10.7% in 2023, reaching historically the highest participation rate. The statistics show that both employers and individuals have actively taken the re-skilling and up-skilling opportunities offered.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Poor quality programmes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Limited funding]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Poor learning outcomes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Low number of professionally trained educators]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
1) Despite specific support measures, there is low motivation to learn and difficulties to combine training with work. According to statistics 48% of adults aged 25-64 did not participate in education or training activities, and 42% of those who did not participate, also do not want to participate. Targeted information and outreach activities will be introduced. 2) For better management, a ministerial-level Human Resource Management Council is established and a Joint Adult Education Coordinating Commission is formed under the Ministry of Economics.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [State monitoring and inspections]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Health and sanitation]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Infrastructure]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Curriculum]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Student-teacher ratio]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [School fees (if relevant)]
No

3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Other]

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

The State Service for Quality in Education monitors the activities of educational institutions and the quality of the education they provide. Health Inspectorate (OVP, periodic health check-ups for education staff).

Solutions developed to reduce emotional and physical violence in educational environments. The Ministry of Education and Science, in cooperation with the Ministry of Health and the Ministry of Welfare, has developed solutions to reduce emotional and physical violence in educational institutions. The solutions involve closer cooperation between national and local authorities to effectively tackle violence in schools. The Cabinet decision will also require amendments to the Education Act to be drafted by 30 September, 2024, stipulating that each educational institution must use an age-appropriate violence reduction and prevention programme. In addition, as a solution to reducing violence, the planned amendments to the Cabinet of Ministers' Regulations require teachers to regularly update their knowledge in the field of children's rights, including on violence reduction. The Child Protection Centre, in cooperation with representatives of the Ministry of Education, has developed an action algorithm for managers of educational institutions in dealing with cases of violence.

Section 14(21) of the Education Law stipulates that the Cabinet of Ministers shall determine the procedure for ensuring preventive health care, first aid and safety of pupils in educational institutions and events organized by them.

Security in educational establishments is regulated by Cabinet of Ministers Regulation No 474, 22 August 2023, Procedure for ensuring preventive health care, first aid and safety of pupils in educational institutions and events organized by them.

Special Education Development Centres aim to provide advisory and methodological support to parents, children, and teachers. Areas of special education development include:

- Providing early diagnosis of special needs for pre-school children, regardless of the place of education;
- providing methodological and pedagogical assistance to teachers of educational institutions in the application of support measures, development of an individual education program learning plan and assessment of the dynamics of learning achievements of a pupil with special needs;
- Developing teaching or methodological support materials to facilitate the integration of learners with special needs into the learning process;
- providing counselling to learners with special educational needs or their legal representatives, irrespective of the place of their education;
- organizing information and educational events, including professional development for teachers on inclusive education and support for learners with special needs;
- cooperation on research issues with universities implementing pedagogical study programmes.
- Special education institutions provide opportunities for learners with special needs to follow vocational basic education programmes after primary education. Cabinet of Ministers Regulation of 4 May 2023 No 220 "Regulations on the procedure for admission to and withdrawal from vocational education programmes".

Special education institutions must also comply with these rules. According to Paragraph 11 of the Regulation, special education institutions shall enroll in a vocational basic education programme financed from the state budget a person who has previously obtained an educational document for having completed a special basic education programme for pupils with mental health disorders, a special basic education programme for pupils with mental development disorders or a special basic education programme for pupils with severe mental development disorders or multiple severe development disorders.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Violence in schools]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Cost of education]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Conflicts or crises]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Inadequate parental support to education]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Long distances to schools]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
In cooperation with Ministry of Health and Ministry of Welfare national Guidelines on reducing bullying at schools are developed. With the support of EU funding, several successful projects with the aim to reduce early school leaving and to identify pupils at risk of dropping out are implemented. Socio-emotional competence and safe and supportive educational environment for children is our priority. Wellbeing issues need to be addressed starting from an early age.
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Teacher training is provided without discrimination.]
Yes
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Teachers’ average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).]
No
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.]
Yes
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.]
No
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.]
Yes
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.]
No

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Establishment of performance monitoring systems.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.]

No

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Other]

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Teachers are trained at higher education level. To become a teacher a person should enter university or college and to complete a full course of professional studies (4 -5 years). Teacher training comprises several components:

- ☒ general education studies
- ☒ studies related to specific subject
- ☒ professional studies.

The qualification of special teacher can be acquired in several ways:

- ☒ by completing a 4 or 4,5 year professional study program in special education;
- ☒ a 2,5 year study program (80-93 credits) for teachers who are already qualified;
- ☒ in masters study programs;
- ☒ by in-service training courses for teachers with qualifications in some other subjects (at least 72 study hours).

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Shortages of teaching staff]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Lack of training centres]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [High student – teacher ratio]

Yes

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Curriculum includes human rights education.]

Yes

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.]

No

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Other]

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Measures have been taken in accordance with 1) Education Development Guidelines 2021-2027; Regulations Regarding the State Basic Education Standard and Model Basic Education Programmes; Regulations Regarding the State General Secondary Education Standard and Model General Secondary Education Programmes

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:]

No

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:][Comment]

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:]

No

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:][Comment]

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:]

No

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:][Comment]

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:]

No

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:][Comment]

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Registration]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [State monitoring and inspections]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Qualifications of teachers]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Health and sanitation]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Infrastructure]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Curriculum]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Student-teacher ratio]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [School fees]

N/A

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [School closures]

N/A

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]

No

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]

No

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [High student – teacher ratio]

No

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Issues in terms of equity and inclusion]

No

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity]

No

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Other]

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.]

Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)]

No

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.]

No

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content , including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.]

No

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.]

No

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education]

No

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.]

No

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.]

No

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:
Main activities in the field of digital transformation: • ☒ increasing the supply of e-learning in vocational, higher and adult education; • ☒ development of e-learning tools and support materials; development of e-learning platforms; • ☒ development of digital and transversal competences: critical thinking and problem solving, creativity and innovation, self-directed learning, collaboration, civic participation, digital literacy. Digital skills are considered technical skills, although they entail cognitive ability to enable the understanding, interpretation, analysis and communication of digital content. They are applied in a variety of different occupations and are increasingly pervading the social aspects of everyone's life. The EDG is designed to support Latvia's relevant national and international commitments. Some of the actions in the EDG continue on from the previous EDG 2014-2020, while others are new. The EDG is developed by the Ministry of Education and Science in collaboration with other skills-relevant ministries, such as the Ministry of Welfare and the Ministry of Economics, amongst others, and a wide range of stakeholders, such as trade unions, the Employers' Confederation of Latvia, the Chamber of Commerce and Industry, and various other institutions and associations. The OECD has supported Latvia in developing its Education Development Guidelines 2021-2027 through the OECD Skills Strategy Latvia project, which has been conducted in two phases: the Assessment and Recommendations Phase (2018-2019) and the OECD Implementation Guidance Phase (2019-2020).
Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework. - Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:
A number of public officials signed a "Computer for every child" Cooperation memorandum, which aims to provide an adequate computer for learning process to every pupil and teacher by 2025.
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Limited access to internet and/or electricity]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.)]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

4. Strengthening governance systems

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.]

Yes

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring results are made public]

Yes

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.]

Yes

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.]

No

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.]

No

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.]

Yes

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.]

No

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.]

Yes

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

To improve the quality and accessibility of special education, municipalities in Latvia invest 14.7 million euros from the European Union funding, promoting the learning performance of students, and creating a learning environment that promotes the well-being of students and teachers.

Government expenditure on education remained above the EU average in 2021, both as a share of GDP (5.6% against an EU average of 4.9%) and as a proportion of total government expenditure (12.6% against an EU average of 9.4%) but maintaining a large and inefficient school network weighs on resource allocation. A comparatively high share of Latvia's education budget was spent on intermediate consumption (18.5%) and on gross capital formation (14%), well above the EU averages of 13.1% and 7.4% respectively, while teacher salaries accounted for 62.5% of education expenditure, compared to an EU average of 64.5%. The 2023 budget increases funding for education and science by more than EUR 180 million, to ensure salary increases for teachers, promote excellence in higher education, and increase science and research capacity for economic transformation.

Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:

Monitoring results are available: https://www.izm.gov.lv/lv/izglitiba-kvalitates-monitoringa-sistema?utm_source=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.google.com%2F

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Budgetary constraints]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels]

No

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions]

No

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages]
No
- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources]
Yes
- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments]
Yes
- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Other]